Lesson 27

DIVINE HEALING PART 2 – SPIRIT, SOUL, AND BODY

Aim: To share the biblical concept and blessing of Divine Healing.

Introduction:

"May your spirit, soul and body be kept safe, sound and without blame." - 1Thes 5:23

God wants us whole (that is, without mental illness, emotional wounds or physical sickness). He desires wholeness in our spirit, soul and body. Sin damages us. Sin damages others– often those we love. Sin can cause illness of spirit, soul and body. Only God can heal these three different parts of our lives (spirit, soul and body) and make us whole again.

What hope and comfort Jesus' words bring to the broken soul when He says: "Go in peace, your faith has made you whole" (Luke 7:50, 8:48).

Yes, God wants to heal the broken and bruised parts of our lives. The Holy Spirit wants every part of our beings to be safe, sound and strong. He desires to bring life and power to our spirits, restore our souls and bring healing to our bodies. These are the blessings which "our great salvation" provides for each one of us.

A. SPIRIT, SOUL AND BODY: THERE IS A DIFFERENCE

It will help us understanding the topic of this section "Healing For The Soul," if we first study the three parts of man.The spirit relates upward to God. The soul relates inward to itself. The body relates outward to the world.

For three-part man to be whole, each part must be in harmony with the others. Every part has a special role or function to play in the well-being of every person. Some Bible students believe there is no difference in meaning between the words "spirit" and "soul." They say both terms refer to that part of man which is not physical or material.

1. What Scripture Shows

It is true that some Scripture verses use either term in that general way. However, in other verses each of these words is used with a special and distinct meaning. The writer of the Book of Hebrews plainly states that there is a difference between the spirit and the soul of man:

"The word of God is alive and powerful. It is sharper than a sword with two cutting edges. It can cut deeply and swiftly. In so doing, it divides or separates the soul from the spirit…"–Hebrews 4:12smf

Note that the Word of God divides… soul… from … spirit, making them separate and distinct entities within us.

Paul points out the difference between the two terms in his first letter to the Corinthian church:

"The natural [soulish] man does not receive the things of God's Spirit. To him they are foolish. He cannot understand them because they can only be judged spiritually…. Only the spiritual man can make such

judgment…"-1 Cor 2:14, 15smf. Note the distinction between the soulish man and spiritual man.

2. What Language Shows

Let us look at the Greek terms in the New testament for spirit, soul and body.

a. Pneuma. The Greek word for "spirit" is pneuma. It means "breath." The lung disease

"pneumonia" takes its name from that term.

b. Psuche. The Greek word for "soul" is psuche. "Psychology," therefore is the study of the

soul (mind) of man.

c. Soma. Finally, the Greek term for "body" is soma. ""Psychosomatic" (soul-body) diseases are disorders of the body which are caused by mental and emotional (soul-related) problems.

These are three Greek terms that have been carefully traced through the New Testament Scriptures. In regard to man's makeup, they are used as follows.

1. Spirit (pneuma) – The "spirit" is that part of man which is aware or conscious of God– God awareness. It is made

"alive" by God's Spirit at salvation. It is "energized" by God's Spirit when we are filled with the Spirit.

The functions of the Spirit include the following.

a. Revelation from God

b. Prayer to God

c. Communion with God

d. Worship of God

e. Witness to man (world)

f. Memory: to recall (remember, reflect)

g. Imagination: to create (envision, dream)

h. Conscience: to judge (discern)

i. Curiosity: to inquire (explore)

j. Perception: to interpret (sense and understand)

k. Fellowship with God (church)

l. Discernment of spirits (spiritual senses)

m. Spiritual warfare

n. Seedbed for the fruit of the Spirit

o. Reception area for the Gifts of the Spirit.

2. Soul (psuche) – The "soul" is that part of an which is aware or conscious of himself– self awareness. It is the

center of the ego or personality. The functions of the soul can be outlined as follows:

a. Reason: to think (meditate, conceive)

b. Emotion: to feel (have passion, affection)

c. Volition: to will (decide)

3. Body (soma) – The "body" is the part of man which is aware of and reacts with the outside world– world awareness. The functions of the body can be outlined as follows.

a. Reception. Information is received from the world by way of the senses (eyes, ears, touch, etc.)

b. Reaction. The body reacts through the motor (muscle) system by words and actions.

c. Expression. The body can express to the world the thoughts, feelings and decisions of the soul.

B. SPIRIT, SOUL, AND BODY: HOW THEY RELATE

We might put these thoughts together in the following way:

1. Soul and Body

Our body receives information (through seeing with our eyes, hearing with our ears, smelling with our nose) by the soul. (To "perceive" means to interpret, judge and

understand what we have to received. To do so, we must rely upon our reason and our memory.)

How we think and feel about a situation will determine what action we will take. In other words, our will or volition now comes to play.We then will do something or say something (a body response). So our soul works with our body and our body with our soul.

2. Spirit and Soul

These relationships of man's three-part being are understood as follows:

The spirit of man is not fully functional because of sin. Before being born of the Holy Spirit (born-again), man's spirit is incapacitated– that is, it doesn't function properly in harmony with God's Spirit.

By being baptized in the Holy Spirit, he receives the spiritual power (or spirit power) he now

needs to live his new life in Christ.

3. Holy Spirit and Soul

"The natural [soulish] man does not receive the things of God's Spirit. To him they are foolish. He cannot understand them because they can only be judged spiritually"– 1Cor 2:14smf.

It is God's purpose that all the functions of man's soul come under the Lordship (governance) of the Holy Spirit. The fruit, gifts and graces given by the Holy Spirit enable the newborn babe in Christ to grow up in the Lord and start obeying God and His Word.

If we grieve the Holy Spirit by natural, soulish ways of living, we will hold back the flow of God's Spirit through our lives. We then fall back into our old (soulish-sensual) way of life.

The Bible calls this being "carnal," or in the "flesh" (see Romans 8:5; Galatians 5:16-26).

D. SPIRIT, SOUL AND BODY; WHAT GOD HAS DONE

Apart from the work of the Holy Spirit in our spirit, we will follow the desires or lusts of the flesh. This is the mark of the "natural" or "soulish" man.

Our desires, however, is to be like Jesus. In His humanity he was the perfect man. He was "spiritual" Because He was like us– totally man in spirit, soul and body– He can relate to us in our human needs and sorrows.

1. Our Relationship To God.

On the cross, He completed "our great salvation. "When He cried out, "It is finished," the work of the redemption was done. Salvation was secured for the spirit, soul and body of man:

a. Justified. Our spirits have been "justified"– made right with God.

b. Sanctified. Our souls are being "sanctified"– made holy before God.

c. Glorified. Our bodies shall be "glorified"– made eternal by the Spirit of God.

Yes, our salvation in Christ covers our total life experience– past, present and future.

2. Our Relationship To Sin

a. We were saved from the "penalty" of sin.

b. We are being saved from the "power" of sin.

c. We shall be saved from the "presence" of sin.

CONCLUSION

The following passage by Paul now takes on added interest for us:

"The body that is sown in death is a natural [psuche] body. However, it will be raised a spiritual [pneuma] body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body."-1Cor 15:44smf.

Paul is telling us that the bodies we now live in here on earth are "soul-bodies." The bodies we will have in Heaven will be "spirit-bodies."

Jesus was raised from the dead by the Holy Spirit. His body after His resurrection was probably a spiritual (pneuma) body. He said, *"Behold I live and am alive forever more."* – Rev 1:18. By that statement He meant He would never die. He had a (pneuma) spiritual body- one that

would live forever.

At our resurrection, we too will have a (pneuma) spiritual body, and our whole being– spirit, soul, and body– will be made perfect in Christ Jesus.

The above should explain all we need to know about spirit, soul and body. This will prepare us for our topic, "Soul Sickness."